

detects and tracks the illegal activity to your address, then you'll have a lot of questions to answer besides paying the hefty bill.

The biggest threat to a wireless network is if it's unprotected, usually because users are ignorant or because of the "chalta hai" attitude. However, an unprotected network can be a nightmare for your security because someone can clearly see your unprotected network on their scan, connect to it and access the host computer with no password or identification at all.

Denial-of-service attacks is another major risk. It can happen even if your network is protected. A DoS attack is almost just as it sounds. Your connection to the internet can be severed by being overrun by thousands of constant transmissions. A DoS attack can completely disable your network and your PC.

Hidden data

Have you every thought about what other data you inadvertently share with someone when you exchange documents? Even if you're just sharing MS Office documents, you may discover that you're inadvertently supplying more information than you realise. This extra data is called Metadata. It contains your name, your company name, the name of the server or hard disk that you stored it on, document revisions, comments etc. Used for a variety of legitimate purposes, it adds functionality to the editing, viewing, filing and retrieving capabilities of Microsoft Office.

But in the wrong hands it can compromise your security and you might end up revealing more to someone than intended; e.g. negative comments that you put in a presentation can be retrieved by your client. In order to avoid these consequences, familiarise yourself with the types of metadata contained in your documents and take steps to remove it whenever necessary. Some basic metadata can be accessed through the Microsoft Office interface but you'll need a binary file editor to access the other metadata. 



In the wrong hands your sensitive data can be used against you